

What is it like to be in early sensory life?

An episode with Anna Ciaunica

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Abstract

In this episode, Anna Ciaunica reviews the recent progress on the scientific study of conscious experiences in early sensory life.

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The video and audio version of this episode are available on <https://aliusresearch.org/bulletin06-ciaunica-podcast.html>

Consciousness is a mystery that many philosophers and scientists have attempted to tackle throughout the centuries. But what if instead of asking what consciousness is, one asks how conscious experiences *emerge, develop and unfold* in our life journey? Let's go back to 'square one' and look at how experiences arise in early human life. What is it like to experience and perceive the world at the dawn of our lives? One basic yet overlooked aspect of current discussions in both philosophy and cognitive neuroscience is that experiences first develop *within* another human body. The most basic perceptions and actions emerge already *in utero*. Crucially, while not all humans will have the experience of being pregnant or carrying a baby, the experience of *perceiving and growing within another person's body* is universal. Why is this important? How can this observation help us to understand conscious experiences?

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